

THE HIKE

OUT & BACK

Avalanche Lake

5.9 mi **757 ft** **3–4 hr**
 ROUND TRIP GAIN MOVING

A gentle, steady climb beside Avalanche Gorge through old-growth cedar and hemlock. Turning around at the **foot of the lake** makes it **4.6 mi** — the extra 0.65 mi each way along the shore buys the classic head-of-lake view of the waterfalls.

GETTING THERE & BACK

- 1 Drive** to the Avalanche Creek parking area on Going-to-the-Sun Road — about **16 mi** past the West Entrance.
- 2 Hike** out and back from the trailhead. No shuttle, no boat — the car stays put all day.
- 3 Drive** back out the way you came.

ON THE WAY

- Trail of the Cedars** — 0.9 mi accessible boardwalk loop sharing the trailhead. Worth the twenty minutes.

Parking fills before sunrise. The Avalanche lot is one of the first to fill on Going-to-the-Sun Road — be parked early, or ride the free park shuttle in and start from the Avalanche stop. Confirm whether a **vehicle reservation** is required for Going-to-the-Sun Road on your dates.

